

Area of Study 4 – Popular Music and Jazz

The study of popular music and jazz spans some of the main genres from the 1950s to songs from Courtney Pine's *Back in the Day* album of 2000 on to the present day. It is a vast field, and honing down to representative works gives a good insight to the key defining works in the genres. The Beatles album *Revolver* is a key work in the study of popular music and the songs represented will provide good focus.

In terms of jazz music, there are many styles, and the cited examples of Bix Beiderbecke *Jazz Me Blues* and Charles Mingus *Blues and Roots* show developments in the music over thirty years or so. More recent developments in the popular music genre are represented by Jay Z's *Blueprint 3* and Björk's *Vulnicura* albums. Features common to both the popular music works and jazz pieces can be studied both in isolation and together.